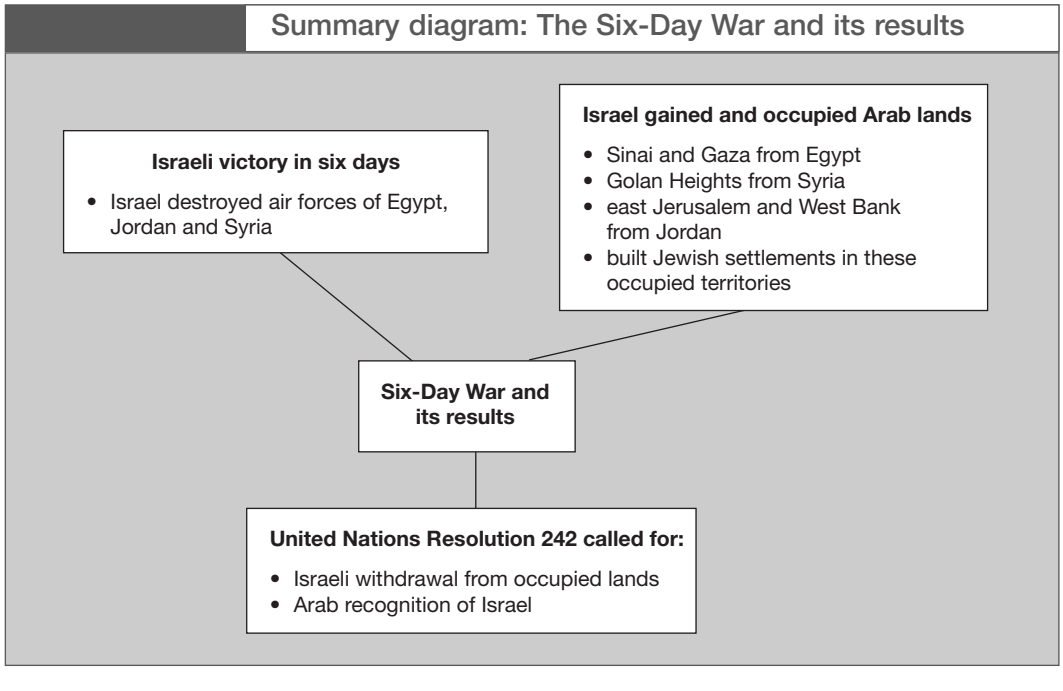
Key date
UN Resolution 242: November 1967

UN Resolution 242

In November 1967, the UN passed Resolution 242 which called for permanent peace based on:

- 'The withdrawal of Israeli armed forces from the territories occupied in the recent conflict.'
- Respect for the right of every state in the area 'to live in peace within secure and recognised boundaries, free from threats or acts of force'.

The Resolution supported the Arabs on the issue of land and supported Israel on the issue of peace and security. Egypt and Jordan accepted the Resolution, effectively recognising Israel's right to exist. Israel held up the 'three noes' of the Arab conference in August as proof that the Arabs did not really want a peace settlement, but the Israeli government eventually accepted the resolution. The UN led discussions with the warring parties but made little progress: Israel found that its occupation of Arab land gave it added security while the Arabs insisted on Israeli withdrawal as a first step to peace.

Many subsequent peace discussions were to be based on the formula of land for peace, most notably those leading to a peace treaty between Israel and Egypt in 1979 (see page 58). But before that, there was to be another war between Israel and its Arab neighbours.

Summary diagram: The Six-Day War and its results